Session 2: Register & Clarity Rewrite Studio

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Part A: One Message, Three Audiences

Core message: The website will be down for two hours on Sunday night for maintenance.

Peer version

FYI, the site will be down for about two hours on Sunday night for maintenance. Please don't schedule any deploys or demos then.

Annotations

- Register: informal, using "FYI" and contractions.
- "About two hours" is acceptable between colleagues.
- It adds the one instruction a teammate needs: avoid deploys and demos.
- No background is given; peers already know why maintenance happens.

Manager version

The website will be offline for two hours on Sunday night for scheduled maintenance. We will post a notice on the status page beforehand and confirm once the site is back. Please let me know if this conflicts with any planned activity.

Annotations

- Register: professional and structured, with the fact first.
- "Scheduled" signals that the downtime is controlled, not an incident.
- It lists what will be communicated, which reassures a manager.
- The last line asks about conflicts, which is the manager's main concern.

Client version

Please note that our website will be unavailable for approximately two hours on Sunday night while we carry out scheduled maintenance. We recommend completing any urgent tasks before then. We appreciate your understanding.

Annotations

- Register: formal and customer-friendly, with "please note" and "approximately".
- "Unavailable" is softer than "down" and avoids technical slang.
- It gives the client something to do: finish urgent tasks early.
- It closes with appreciation instead of an apology, since this is planned work.

Part B: Three Ambiguous Sentences, Rewritten

Ambiguous sentence	Two possible meanings	Clear rewrite	Rule and why it works
The vendor said the delivery would be late during the call.	The delivery would be late during the call, or the vendor spoke during the call.	During the call, the vendor said the delivery would be late.	A time phrase at the end can attach to the wrong verb. Moving it to the front ties it to "said".

Ambiguous sentence	Two possible meanings	Clear rewrite	Rule and why it works
I trust Ravi more than Meera.	I trust Ravi more than Meera trusts Ravi, or I trust Ravi more than I trust Meera.	I trust Ravi more than I trust Meera.	In comparisons after "than", words are often left out. I add the missing verb so the comparison is clear.
Describe the process in the document with examples.	The examples go with the process, or the document contains examples.	In the document, describe the process and include examples.	A pile of phrases leaves the attachment open. Separate verbs for separate actions remove the doubt.